

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Mohammad Usman Sadjid

Address: 23 Gomshall Road Cheam Sutton SM2 7JZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Case Officer,

My name is Mohammad Usman Sadjid, and I have been a resident of the local area since 2019. I am writing to express my full support for Planning Application DM2025/01591 relating to the proposed conversion of the former Sutton Ambulance Station on Dorset Road into a community and worship facility.

1. Understanding of the Site and Its Previous Use

The former Sutton Ambulance Station operated as a 24-hour emergency service facility, with vehicle movements and operational activity occurring at all times of day and night. This level of activity was part of the established character of the site for many years.

In comparison, the proposed community and worship use represents a significantly lower-intensity and more predictable use of the building. Activity will be concentrated at specific times and managed in an organised manner, rather than the unpredictable nature of emergency response operations historically associated with the site.

2. First-Hand Experience of Responsible Operation

I regularly attend Friday prayers (Jumaa) and other activities organised by BASMA, and I have seen first-hand how responsibly and respectfully the congregation operates.

Friday prayers have been effectively staggered to avoid conflict with school pick-up times and peak local traffic periods. This demonstrates a proactive and cooperative approach to managing impact on the surrounding area.

Over the years I have attended, I have observed orderly arrival and departure patterns, respectful behaviour towards neighbours, and a strong emphasis on maintaining good relations within the wider community.

3. Sustainable Travel and Local Accessibility

The proposal includes 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays, alongside cycle racks that encourage sustainable travel.

From my own experience, many attendees walk, car-share, or use public transport. Arrival and departure times are naturally staggered, reducing pressure on surrounding streets.

My family and I have previously discussed the benefit of having a permanent community and worship facility within reasonable walking distance of our home. A location such as this supports sustainable travel patterns and reduces reliance on vehicles, which is positive for both residents and the wider environment.

I do not believe the development will result in significant traffic, light, or noise concerns.

4. Community Benefit and Social Cohesion

There is a clear and genuine need for this facility.

Through attending BASMA, I have personally experienced the sense of community, belonging, and positive engagement it fosters. I have seen people from diverse cultural and ethnic backgrounds come together in a respectful and unified environment. It strengthens social cohesion and promotes understanding across communities.

The proposed centre will provide:

Dedicated space and programmes for women,

Educational activities and structured learning for children,

Community wellbeing initiatives,

A safe and inclusive environment for families.

As a parent, I value the positive environment and sense of community that BASMA provides, something I had not previously experienced before becoming involved. This facility would allow those benefits to continue and grow in a stable, permanent location.

5. Appropriate and Modest Use of the Site

The building is modest in scale and appropriate for the surrounding area. The proposal maintains greenery and respects the character of the site while bringing a currently unused building back into productive community use.

It represents a low-intensity and community-focused development, fully aligned with the principles of sustainable and socially beneficial planning.

Conclusion

As a local resident since 2019 and a regular attendee who has witnessed the operation and its positive impact first-hand, I strongly believe this proposal is:

Appropriate for the site,

Responsibly managed,

Community-serving in nature, and

Unlikely to generate significant adverse impact.

For these reasons, I respectfully urge the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591.

Yours faithfully,

Mr Mohammad Usman Sadjid

23 Gomshall Road, Cheam, Sutton, Surrey, SM2 7JZ